Implicit tensor entries: traversal, preparation and retention audit

4 November 2026. Claim record PCC-20261104-1df881 has standing unverified. This is a source-inspection statement, with candidate proof obligations and resource expressions; it is not a general complexity theorem. All source observations and interpretations below are unverified assertions. [pcc:unverified]

The concrete advance is a map from target-row budgets to entry traversal, including the work and storage outside that traversal. It narrows the next proof task to local bookkeeping invariants and an aggregate cost ledger.

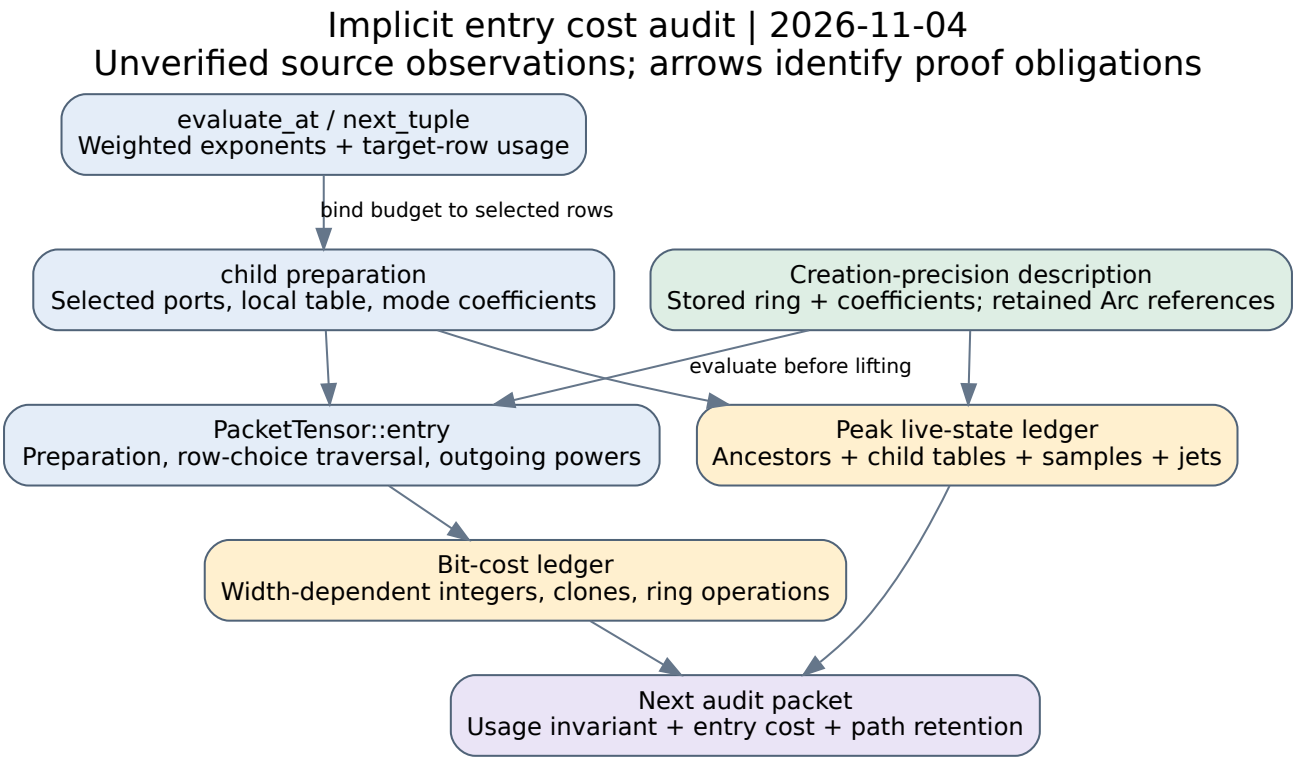


Figure 1: Evidence dependencies; no timing data.

Scope and sources

Native source is pinned to crypto main 2d746d0577ddf797b8706de1f45489fb31ad3d31. Relevant contraction files have the same blobs as the prior assessment snapshot, while surrounding main has advanced. The earlier assessment (../hashed_ecdl_leads_20261030/README.md) and bridge (../hashed_ecdl_leads_20261030/BRIDGE.md) remain unchanged. Sources and locators are in sources.json (sources.json); the structured audit ledger is audit-map.json (audit-map.json). [pcc:unverified]

Primary text: OpenAI, *The Exponential Time Hypothesis is False*, Appendix D.1 and D.4.5-D.4.7. The current publisher path's last-change commit is 42907c9e (https://github.com/openai/math/tree/42907c9e999cc00d6abe7a50bfc1023250edd1b9/preprints/The-Exponential-Time-Hypothesis-is-False-October-25-2026). Its PDF blob matches the cached PDF used to extract the reviewed text, also available at the older implementation pin 7ef5c0cc. The theorem permits an exponential entry-work allowance, rather than requiring each entry to take polynomial time. The child-entry argument uses bounded affine row products and fixed creation descriptions; the total-call argument prices entry evaluations separately. These are source statements, not independently checked results here. [pcc:unverified]

Atlas main 774611edb0a58861c2991372b81e49be0a0644b4 now contains LEAD-EXO-hashed-factor-base-tensor-ecdl. This round advances its independent audit action; it does not repeat the already delivered selector, width, partial-relation or binary implementations. Relevant atlas matching was run; no complete atlas-delta review or new mechanism is claimed. [pcc:unverified]

The newly isolated link: target rows to incoming modes

evaluate_at builds a bound for each packet/target group by counting real row ports with that group label. next_tuple increments the matching usage when increasing a mode exponent, and subtracts it on carry/reset. child selects the same packet/group rows and retains only positive exponents as incoming records. The per-packet entry then consumes those exponents across its row choices. These are the precise source sites to join in one invariant, rather than treating incoming-mode count as a new independent free parameter. [pcc:unverified]

Next local obligation: establish that every enumerated tuple's target usage equals its sum of incoming exponents and does not exceed the selected row count. Under that invariant, positive incoming records are controlled by the same row budget. This conditional interpretation is not a completed formal proof of the enumerator, of weighted-mode coverage, or of its cost. [pcc:unverified]

Symbols for the audit ledger

Symbol	Meaning
R, C	Selected row and column ports of one packet/group
ell	Packet slot capacity; distinct from total description length
q, h	Positive incoming and outgoing mode-record counts
E	Sum of incoming exponents for the entry
B, K	Total modes and packets at the current call
D, p	Extension-ring coordinate count and current coefficient precision
I, J	Interpolation samples and retained tapered coefficients

These are symbolic source dimensions, not measured values. Local container lengths do not by themselves specify allocator bytes or peak process memory.

Source-to-cost and storage ledger

Component	Observed loops/data	Quantity the general audit must price
child selection	Scans packet slots; retains old vertices by Arc; builds local row/column arrays	All groups for every tuple, including graph/port allocation and label scans
Packet preparation	Local R-by-C table of Elements; q row-coefficient lists; outgoing sparse terms; repeated linear lookups in mode lists	Table construction, coefficient lookup/clone work, stored D-coordinate values and p-bit arithmetic
Entry preparation	Constants per row and q coefficient lists are built before the E>R zero shortcut	Preparation still costs work when extraction returns zero immediately
Coefficient traversal	Depth-first row choices with remaining exponents, exhausted-mode/zero-factor filters and row-capacity pruning	Attempted choices, rejected choices and ring products; not just accepted monomials
Entry scratch	Constants, coefficient lists, prefix products, row-choice vectors and remaining exponents	Simultaneously live Elements and integer/vector overhead, not all full row assignments
Outgoing evaluation	Sparse coefficient sums followed by Ring::pow and multiplication	BigUint addition/remainder plus repeated-squaring products for every retained power
Tuple/group driver	Weighted tuple vector, per-group usage and bounds; group children visited sequentially	Carry/reset scans, child preparation and every evaluated child before zero-product shortcuts
Interpolation/recovery	Sample nodes/values and tapered jets; rational numerators/denominators in recovery	Concurrent ancestor state, retained coefficients and rational bit growth

All rows are source observations and open cost obligations, not calibrated operation counts or independently checked bounds. [pcc:unverified]

Traversal contract to check

PacketTensor::entry has an explicit depth-first traversal. It branches on a constant term or an available incoming mode for each row, decrements the chosen exponent, and restores it when backing up. It rejects zero factors and prefixes with more required degree than remaining rows. The traversal's scratch contains a prefix-product vector rather than a table of all complete choices. A proposed cost bound must include unsuccessful choice scans as well as coefficient additions and products. [pcc:unverified]

The source's row-product argument is the relevant comparator for this inner traversal. To transfer it, connect packet capacity, positive-exponent support, ring precision and mode-description size uniformly to the root parameters. This review does not replace that induction with a numerical experiment or with a low-rank assertion. The row budget narrows a proof obligation; it does not establish the whole recursive bound. [pcc:unverified]

Creation precision and live descriptions

Tensor::entry evaluates a stored packet at its own creation ring and only then lifts coordinates. child copies retained Arc references without wrapping an old entry callback inside a new packet. New packets store local coefficient data and incoming/outgoing records. This confirms the earlier source map's representation reading; nested parent-evaluator composition is not the outstanding issue identified in this code. [pcc:unverified]

The remaining retention ledger must combine ancestors' packing and mode data, old packet descriptions still reachable through Arc, newly prepared child tables, interpolation samples and accumulated jets. Depth-first traversal avoids retaining every sibling contraction, but it does not make all ancestor state disappear. child_precision increases the working precision by node and evaluation losses; the audit must bound those widths along the path. [pcc:unverified]

Logical meter units and bit cost

The public Meter explicitly describes diagnostic primitive steps. Ring addition charges coordinates, while multiplication charges selected coefficient products and reduction updates. Integer coefficient multiplication still depends on operand width. Mode construction also calls BigUint modular exponentiation directly, and outgoing sparse sums use addition/

remainder without a separate charge inside that loop. Coefficient cloning and allocator work must also appear in a bit/space ledger. [pcc:unverified]

Meter::vector checks one requested length; it is not an aggregate live-byte counter. Meter::bits checks a supplied width; it is not a cost model for every operation at that width. These distinctions do not establish a semantic bug or a violation of the source theorem. They identify why a meter total alone cannot certify the required bit complexity or total retained space. [pcc:unverified]

Next discriminating proof packet

1. State and check the tuple-weight and target-usage invariants across an increment, carry/reset and termination, including the empty-mode case.

2. Bind child's selected rows and positive incoming records to that usage; record preparation before the zero-entry shortcut.

3. Account for the coefficient traversal and outgoing powers with an explicit arbitrary-precision arithmetic model; include skipped and failed choices.

4. Sum retained descriptions, scratch, modes, samples and jets along a strict shrinking path, using the source precision bounds at each creation point.

This is a review packet with checkable interfaces. A complete proof or a specific disagreement would decide the next action. No runtime guard, precision convention, mode contribution or verifier has been changed.

Delivery and evidence status

This source map and its structured ledger are the deliverable for this round. The statement record has no proof artifacts and no signed verdict; its standing is unverified. A new theorem, independent kernel check, identity certificate or measurement is not asserted. The existing general-audit problem remains open with the local obligations above. [pcc:unverified]

The PDF (report.pdf), editable diagram (dependency.dot), and document renderer (render_report.py) accompany the report. Existing canonical leaderboard, progress and curve graphs receive no new measured value or transport edge. No scientific experiment, benchmark, challenge solve or paid resource ran. Source snapshots and all old reports/manifests are preserved.